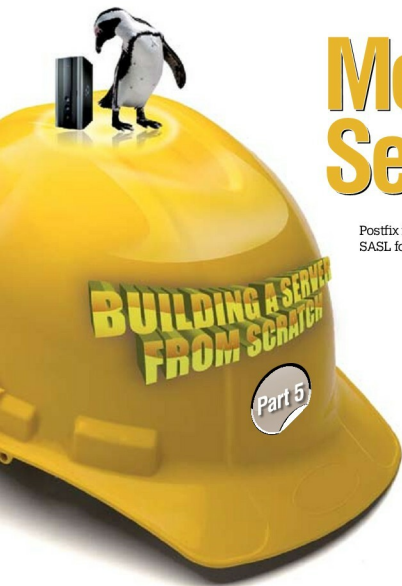




Messaging Services

Postfix for an MTA, Dovecot for POP/IMAP, and Cyrus-SASL for authentication... Are you ready for them?

This way, you are not bound to the server architecture I've defined, but can set up each role in your own way. You decide all the low-level details such as disk space allocation, VM set-up and all that, while I write about the way to set up each specific service.



Note: You have got to be mentally prepared to handle the barrage of settings and different configuration combinations that messaging services can throw at you. You'll also need to understand a bit of messaging terminology. You'll also need a Web server and a MySQL server. PostgreSQL will not do.

Terminology

Let's learn a bit about messaging terminology:

1. Mail Transfer Agent (MTA): This is the program that actually sends messages from your account to other accounts and receives mail from other accounts.
2. MX Record: The Mail eXchanger record in a DNS system specifies the machine that is used to handle e-mail on the network. There can be multiple MX records for a given network.
3. Post Office Protocol (POP) 3: POP is a protocol, such as HTTP, used for communication between a mail client

Hey, I hope you've fiddled around with that WordPress installation enough to suit your needs. Or, did you install Drupal or Joomla instead? Whichever CMS it is, I'm sure you've been able to customise it to your requirements.

As promised earlier, this month we'll concentrate on setting up a mail server. However, there's a slight change in the instruction model: I'll write about each role in a generalised way from now on.